

VESPER — Game Idea Submission | Team: CD project blaxk

1. One-Line Pitch

A 2.5D puzzle-action platformer where a moving light makes the drawn world real—until our protagonist, **Vesper**, survives their scripted death and must fight to survive in the shadows when that same light begins hunting them.

2. Theme Justification

All three themes drive both the world and the core gameplay mechanics rather than acting only as visual style:

- **Light:** Light shifts meaning across each stage of the game—starting as safety, turning into danger, and finally becoming something the hero must choose to face. Mechanically, anything drawn in the world is only solid and colored while lit; in the dark, objects fade into gray ghosts that the player passes right through.
 - **Comic:** The game takes place inside an illustrated story where a dynamic Narrator speaks through caption boxes and attacks pop with visual sound-effect text like *"THWACK!"*. The Narrator's captions react to the player, offering jokes and hints early on before shifting to warnings in the second half.
 - **Twist:** The narrative centers on a secret late-game plot twist, mirrored by a genre twist that transforms the experience from a calm light-puzzle platformer into a tense action-survival game.
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3. Gameplay Idea & Core Mechanics

The gameplay runs on a 2D path through a 3D world and follows three core rules of light:

1. **Light Makes the World Real:** Platforms, bridges, doors, and walls are only solid and in color while illuminated. Long platforms are split into segments so a light beam can solidify specific sections of a bridge, and objects flicker briefly before turning ghostly so the player is never dropped without warning.
2. **Shadows Count as Darkness:** Pushing a crate into a light beam casts a shadow, and anything drawn inside that shadow turns ghostly again. A locked gate covered in shadow can be walked straight through, though every shadow also acts as a doorway for monsters lurking in the dark.
3. **Moving Light Mechanics:**
 - **Act 1 — The Lamp (Player-Controlled Light):** The player moves and aims the Lamp's beam to solidify terrain and cast shadows, narrowing the beam to reach far distances or widening it to cover a larger area nearby.
 - **Act 2 — The Searchlight & The Ember (Hostile Moving Light):** After the twist, the Lamp turns against Vesper and sweeps across the levels as a patrolling searchlight. Standing in the beam fills an erase meter that costs health, forcing the player to hide in shadows, lure monsters into the beam to erase them, and cross along the very edge of the enemy's moving light to keep platforms solid underfoot. To navigate the dark, Vesper carries a small **Ember** that lights a tight radius around them.

Movement & Combat

- **Platforming:** Tight 2D movement with variable jump height, a brief grace period to jump after leaving a ledge, and buffered jump inputs.
 - **Combat & Fuel:** In the second part, Vesper unlocks directional slashes, a brief invincibility dash, and a downward strike that bounces off enemies and hazards. Hitting light-reactive monsters refills the shrinking Ember's fuel, which the player can spend to **Heal** or trigger a **Flash** that stuns enemies and briefly illuminates distant platforms.
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4. Game Flow & Level Progression

Levels progress across three distinct parts, shifting both atmosphere and gameplay loop:

Part	Look, Mood & Audio	Gameplay Flow
1. The Lit Levels (Puzzle Loop)	Warm, colorful, and comedic where light falls, with grayscale in the dark and playful acoustic music. Includes a brief flash-forward scene to hook players early.	Enter Level → Read the Scene (spot light, dark, and shadow) → Shape the Light (aim the Lamp and push crates) → Reach Checkpoint , ending with a boss fight.
2. The Margins (Survival Loop)	Inverted black-and-white ink lines, low audio drones, a rising hum warning before the searchlight moves, and comic relief from discarded draft characters.	Explore the Dark (guided by the Ember) → Evade the Sweeping Searchlight in Shadows → Fight Monsters to Refuel → Spend Fuel to Flash or Heal → Reach Checkpoint .
3. The Desk (Final Climax)	The camera pulls out from the flat page to reveal a fully 3D desk at night under a real desk lamp, backed by an emotional piano theme.	A single final boss fight that combines both loops—requiring the player to aim the light and fight at the same time.

5. Team Details — CD project blaxk

#	Member Name	ID	IndieConnect ID	Role & Responsibilities
1	Mohammad Dhilawala	mohammad.dhillawala@research.iiit.ac.in	mohd	Gameplay Programmer — Player movement, combat, enemies, the Lamp, Ember, and Searchlight mechanics
2	Shubham Gupta	sg04032007@gmail.com	jaddukakaddu	Systems Programmer — Light-reactive objects, shadow logic, camera transitions, and checkpoints
3	Kalp Doshi	kalp.doshi@students.iiit.ac.in	kalp_doshi	Level Designer — Level layouts, puzzle setups, searchlight patrol paths, and boss arena design
4	Ridhim Mittal	ridhim2609@gmail.com	ridhim2609	Artist — 2D character and prop sprites, skeletal animation, shaders, and the three environment looks
5	Aarav Muni	aarav.muni@gmail.com	aarav.muni	Audio, Narrative & UI — Music themes, paper and ink sound effects, caption writing, and menus